

RRTC on Advancing Employment

Bringing Employment First to scale

State of the Science
Listening Session
APSE, 2017





Research & Training Center on Community Living

UNIVERSITY OF MINNESOTA

Driven to DiscoverSM

NASDDDS



DirectCourse
ONLINE CURRICULA FOR LIFE IN COMMUNITY

ThinkWork!

“Employment is a way for people with disabilities to give to the community and see what they have to offer.

We’re givers, not just takers.”

(Max Barrows, SABE)

1970s



Try another way

1980s



Supported Employment



Self employment

1990 + ...



Customized employment

ThinkWork!

Policy Influences

Olmstead Decision

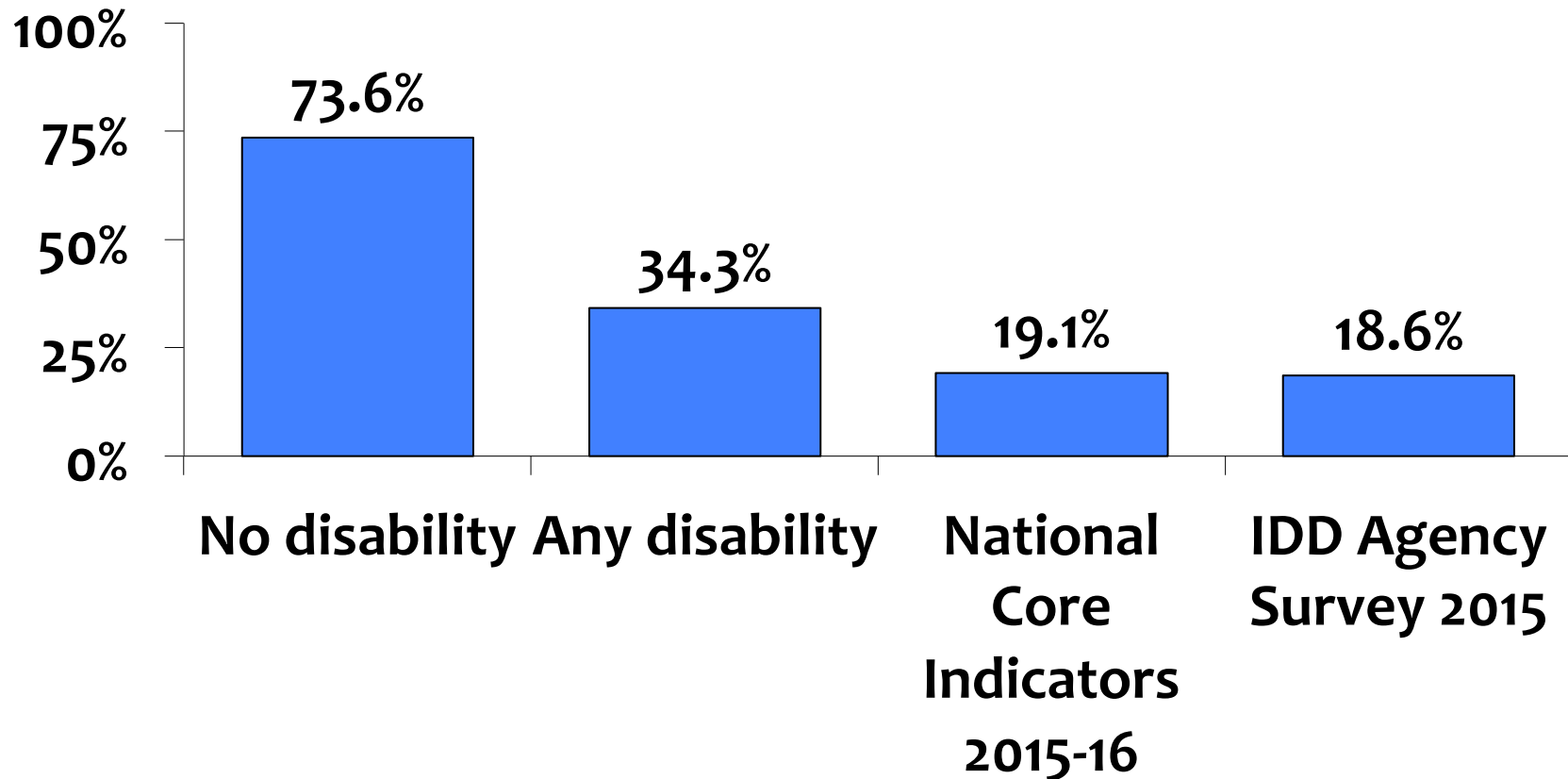
CMS Employment Guidance

CMS Settings Rule

Department of Justice

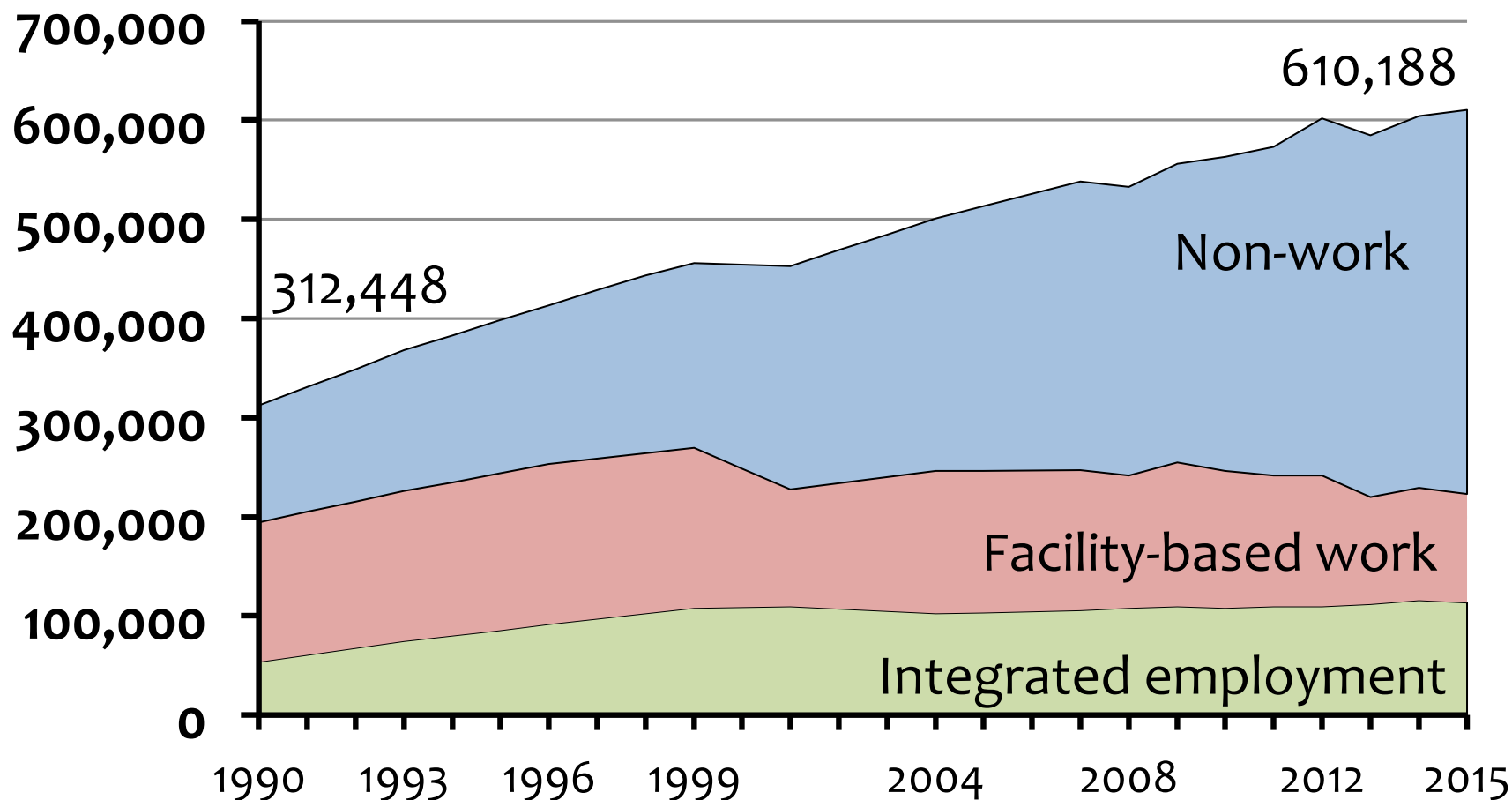
WIOA

How many people are employed?



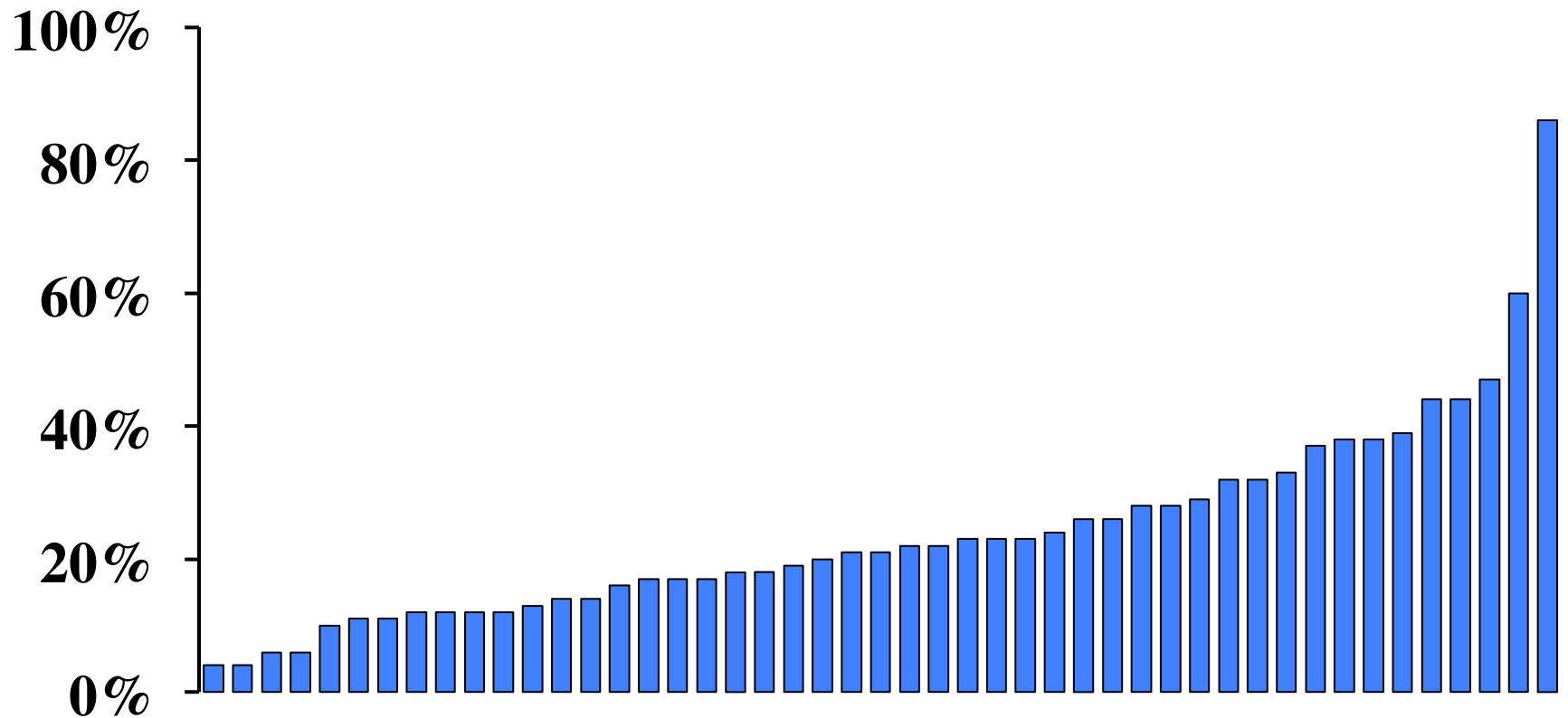
But what's a job ...

Number in Employment and Day Services



Source: ICI National Survey of State IDD
Agency Day and Employment Services

Participation in integrated employment services varies widely



Source: ICI National Survey of
State IDD Agencies 2015

Other fast facts...

4 ... % of job developers' time spent with employers

6... # of states reporting 40% or more of individuals served in integrated employment (IE) services

9... % of CRP staff working in IE

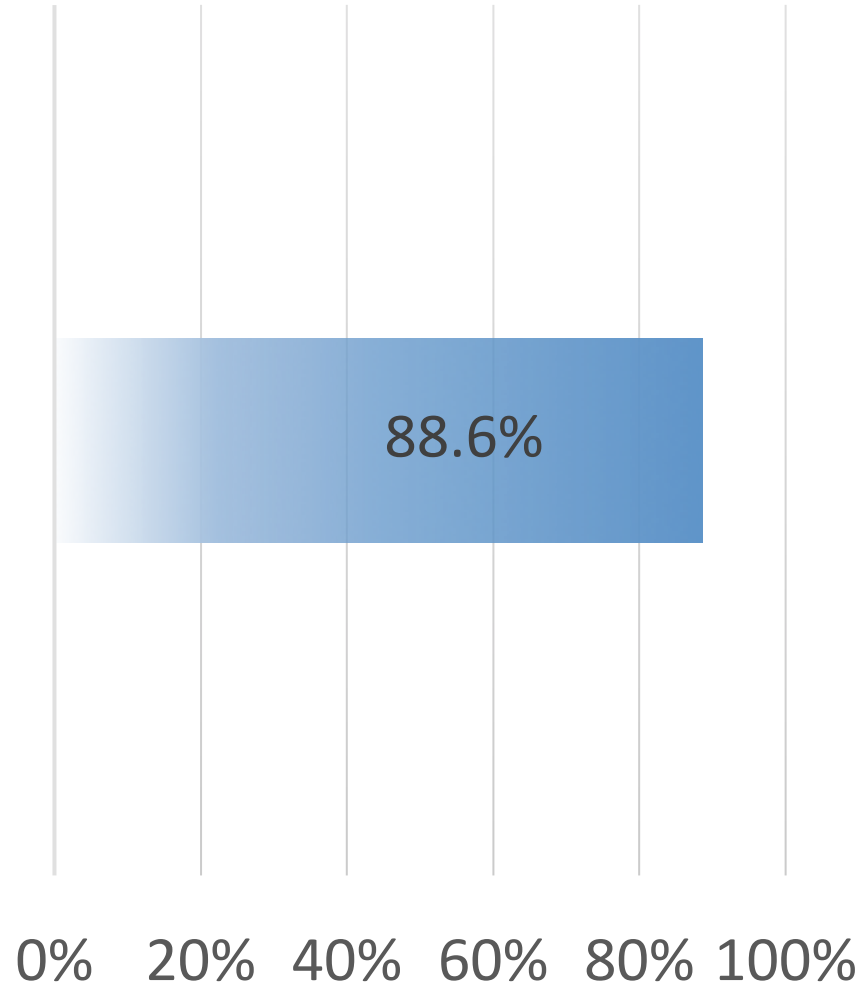
13.5...% of IDD agency day and employment \$\$ spent on IE

19... % of individuals with IDD working in the community

47... % of individuals who don't work but want to

Changing culture and structure

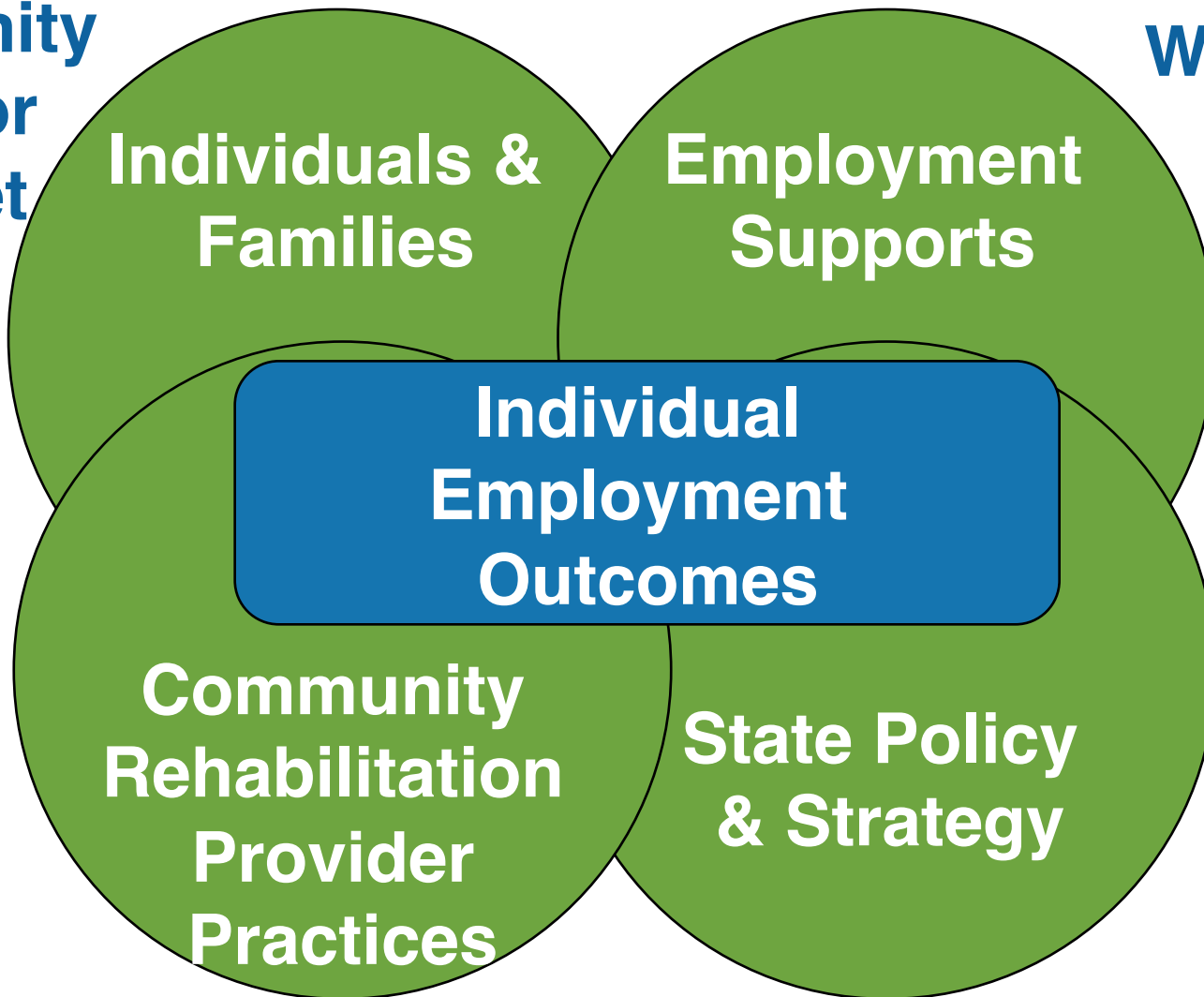
**Facility-based programs
are needed [for]
individuals who have
difficulty or are unable
to maintain
employment**



Holistic Perspective

**Community
& Labor
Market**

Workplace



Federal Policy

ThinkWork!

Why is research important?



RRTC State of the Science initiative

Overall purpose:

- ❖ Share findings with key stakeholders and thought leaders
- ❖ Inform ongoing work
- ❖ Confirm implications and set the agenda for future research

www.thinkwork.org/sos2017

3 Organizing Themes

- ❖ Meaningful engagement and involvement of individuals and families in the employment process
- ❖ Provider agencies' capacity to carry out effective employment supports
- ❖ Policies at both the state and national levels underscore and prioritize employment

Process

- ❖ Roll out over a six month process
- ❖ Development of draft papers with external expert reviewers
- ❖ Three pronged approach:
 - In person listening sessions
 - Online events
 - In person meeting in Washington, DC.

“Knowledge to action” agenda that will help to shape future priorities and move research findings into everyday practice.

Organizational capacity to carry out effective employment supports – what is the vision?

- Clear yet flexible practice model.

- efficient approach to providing implementation support.

- effective cost-efficient approach to supporting transformation.



Background

Despite identified best practices for employment consultants and providers, implementation of practices is inconsistent and the number of individuals working in the community has remained stagnant.

What we know

- ❖ Extensive literature on effective supports practices
- ❖ 35,000 employment consultants, nationally (estimated)
- ❖ Majority of employment consultants assisting up to 5 job seekers with IDD getting jobs per year
- ❖ Limited implementation of best practice

Research questions: Implementation

- ❖ How do effective employment specialists implement supports?
- ❖ How can we provide efficient/effective implementation support?
- ❖ What is the effectiveness of data-based feedback, online training, and a community of practice?

Research questions: Transformation

- ❖ What are the most important features necessary for successful organizational transformation?
- ❖ Can we efficiently support transformation using organizational assessment, distance support, and a community of practice?

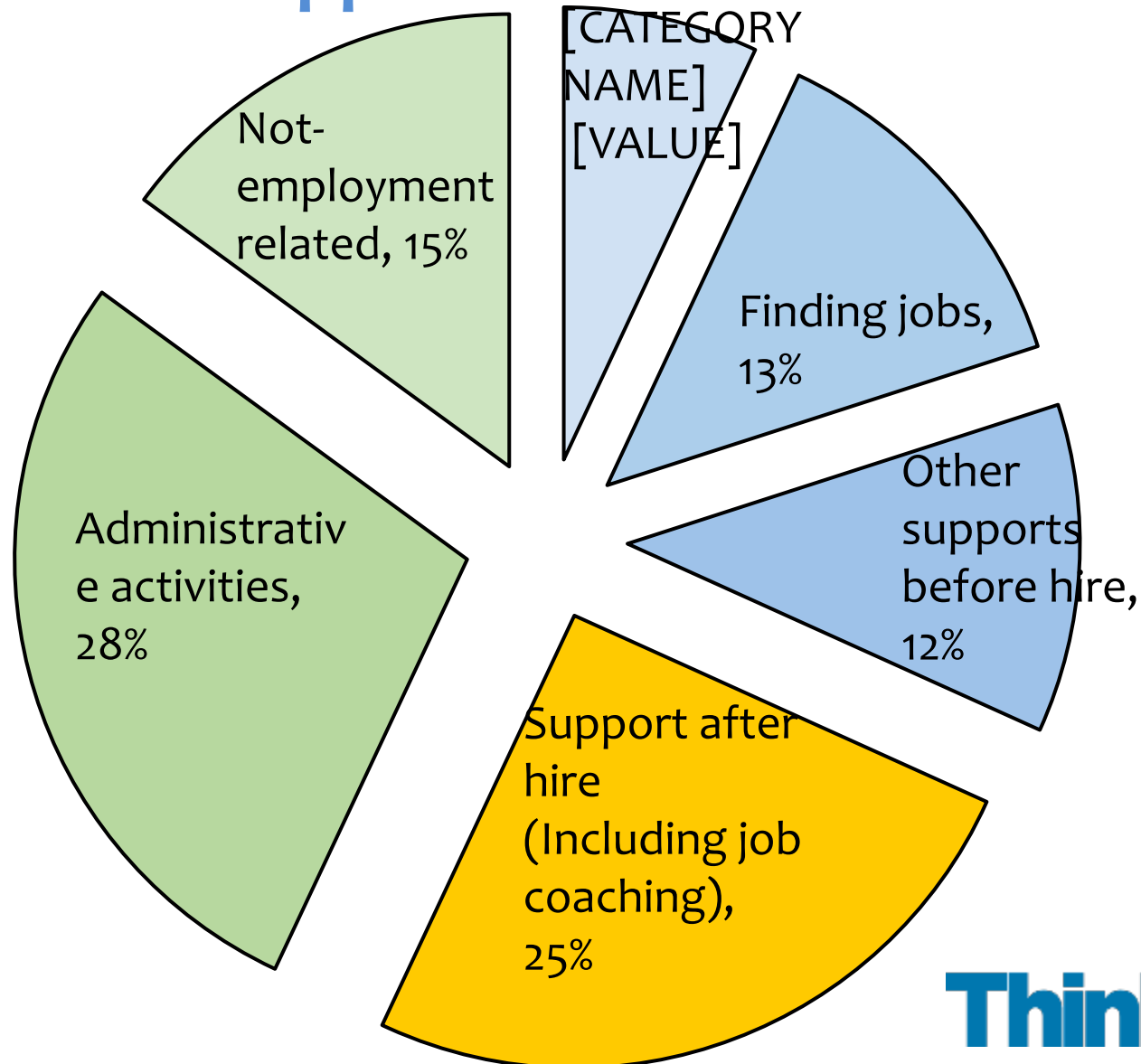
The studies

- ❖ In-depth interviews with employment consultants, supervisors, families and individuals
- ❖ Employment consultant intervention (in process)
- ❖ Delphi panel and case studies around organizational transformation
- ❖ Intervention with providers (in process)

Comprehensive model of employment support



How do employment consultants invest their time across support activities?



10 key elements for organizational transformation

- ❖ Clear and consistent goals
- ❖ Agency culture that values include
- ❖ Strong communications plan
- ❖ Active, person-centered planning process
- ❖ Re-allocated and restructured resources
- ❖ Ongoing investment in professional development
- ❖ Focus on customer engagement
- ❖ Effective employment performance measurement, quality assurance, and program oversight
- ❖ Holistic approach
- ❖ Community partnerships

Focus & Values

Goals

Culture of inclusion



Infrastructure

Resource allocation

Communication plan

Staff development

Performance

measurement

Community partnerships



Employment Consultant Practices

Customer engagement

Holistic approach

Active job placement



Where are we going?



In the next 5-10 years, what should research focus on to optimize capacity of employment consultants and employment programs?

think/move/vote!

2 types of sticky notes on your table



✓ VOTE with the little sticky notes

💬 COMMENT with the big sticky notes

Meaningful engagement of individuals and families. What is the vision?

Employment as a lifelong conversation.

Information and support available on a “just in time” basis

Types and pathways for information and support are effective, accessible, simple



Background

Families can be the most influential part of successful employment and life planning, yet often lack the knowledge to move employment from an abstract thought to a real job.

Research questions

- ❖ What does the literature say about successful strategies in engaging families in employment?
- ❖ How can we share information in a way that is most useful for families?

The studies

- ❖ Scoping literature review
- ❖ In-person and online forums and focus groups
- ❖ Family engagement intervention (in process)

Key findings

Literature

- ❖ Family modeling shapes employment experiences
- ❖ Engaging families supports employment focus
- ❖ Family/individual demographics are related to employment

Forums

- ❖ Confusing guidance and low systems expectations
- ❖ Navigation is hard: Misalignments & discontinuities
- ❖ System lacks capacity
- ❖ More success when rely on self and family

Engagement strategies

Training

- Explore, Prepare, Act
- FEAT

Online resources

- Let's Get to Work (WI)

Planning tools

- Arc Future Planning
- LifeCourse tools

Peer to peer outreach

Social media

Intervention with the Arc – ongoing

- ❖ Center for Future Planning Tool
- ❖ Goal is enrollment for 100 families (PwD age 14-24)
- ❖ 3 part strategy
 - Facebook reminders to log in/use the tool
 - Encouraging/inspiring messages about employment
 - Information and referral

Where are we going?



In the next 5-10 years, what should research focus on that would optimize family expectations and family engagement around work?

think/move/vote!

Remember...



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Aligning policy and practice across agencies – what is the vision?



Systems intentionally align practices (**what we do**) with a priority for employment (**what we want**) and bring components to scale (**availability for all**)

APSE EMPLOYMENT FIRST STATEMENT

Adapted by Green Mountain Self Advocates and Self Advocates Becoming Empowered

All people with disabilities should have opportunities to work. Public dollars should be used to pay for supports for people to work in the community.

People with disabilities, their families, and their allies believe that:



Too many people with disabilities do not have a job. This is unacceptable.



All people should have opportunities for real jobs with real wages. It will get us out of poverty. We will be more independent. We will feel more included.

All people, with and without disabilities, can work in jobs together earning minimum wage or higher.



Like everyone else, people with disabilities should have access to supports that they need to work successfully.



All people, no matter what disability they have, have the right to work a job they choose that matches their skills and interests.



Public policies must support people with disabilities having real jobs. Money for services should be spent on people having jobs in the community.



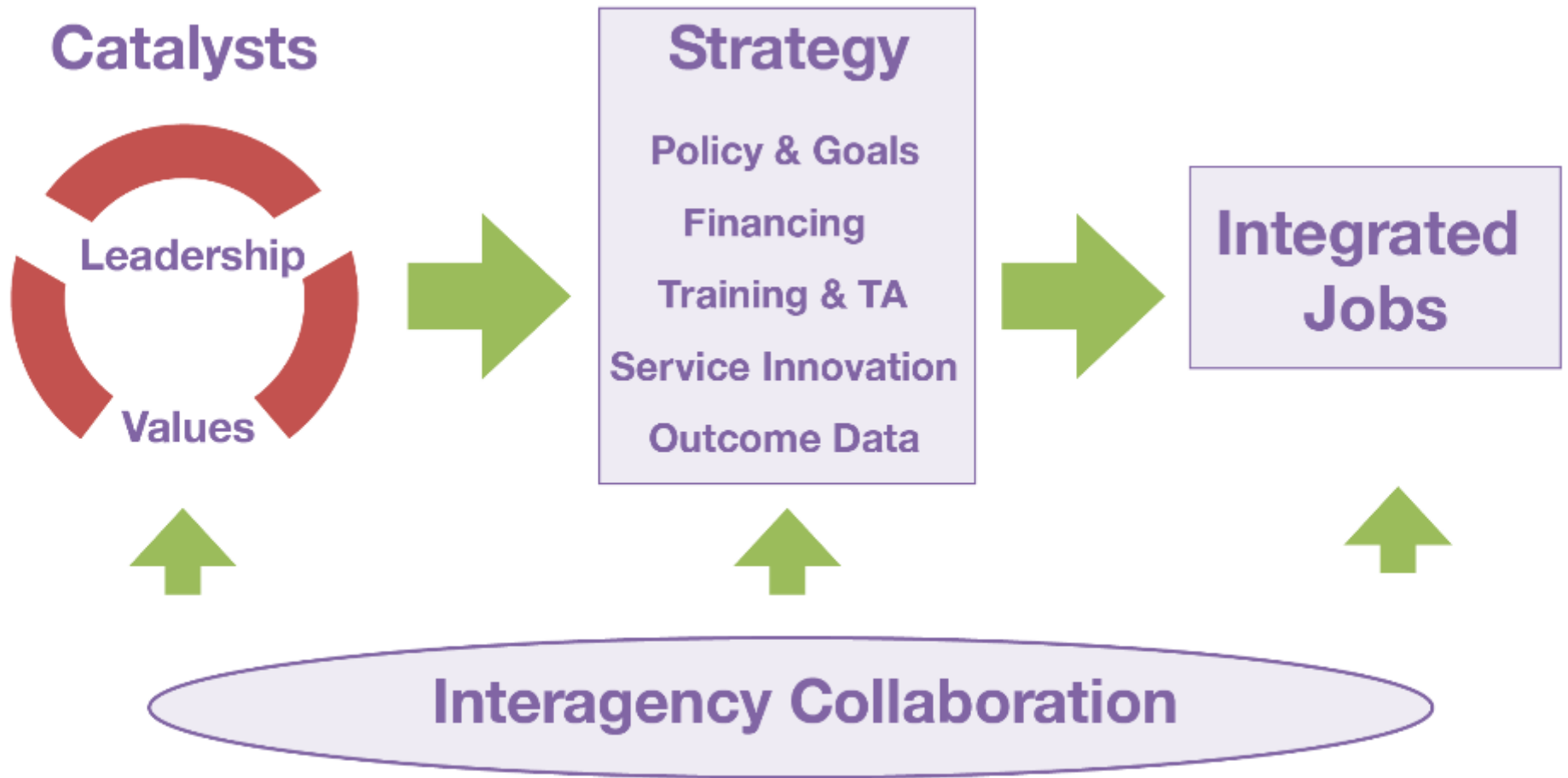
Just calling your state an Employment First state is not enough. "Employment First" is when everyone who wants a job, has a job.



“just calling your state an
‘Employment First’
state is not enough;
it’s when everyone
who wants a job,
actually has a job.”
(SABE, 2017).

State Policy & Strategy

High-Performing Framework



Research questions

- ❖ What are the characteristics of “higher performing” employment systems?
- ❖ What is the relationship between systems’ characteristics and employment outcomes?

The studies

- ❖ Development of state rankings across 3 systems (education, VR, IDD)
- ❖ Case study research of the “highest performers”
- ❖ Digging deeper: policy analysis with state examples

Key findings: composite indicator

	Rank	Overall CI Score	IDD Score	VR Score	Education Score
MD	1	47.38	21.60	15.22	10.56
NH	2	47.26	22.76	9.63	14.86
VT	3	46.88	22.76	13.75	10.37
OR	4	44.77	21.60	12.81	10.35
WA	5	44.26	22.84	10.87	10.56
IA	6	42.48	15.42	13.78	13.28
OK	7	41.98	21.67	12.79	7.52
SD	8	40.51	14.33	14.72	11.46
CO	9	39.78	14.47	13.92	11.39
DE	10	39.60	19.20	14.32	6.08

Top Performers Across Systems and States

Top 10 states based on CI Scores (ranked descending order)

- **Maryland**
- **New Hampshire**
- Vermont
- Oregon
- Washington
- Iowa
- Oklahoma
- **South Dakota**
- **Colorado**
- Delaware

Top IDD System Performers

- **Maryland**
- **New Hampshire**
- Vermont
- Oregon
- Washington
- Oklahoma

Top VR System Performers

- **Maryland**
- **South Dakota**
- **Colorado**
- Delaware

Top Education System Performers

- **New Hampshire**
- Iowa
- **South Dakota**
- **Colorado**



Key findings: case study research

- ❖ Success over the long-term depends on a cadre of stakeholders
- ❖ Leadership is most effective when distributed across multiple levels of responsibility
- ❖ Consistent allocation of funds for long-term services for youth exiting schools is critical. Cements expectation for collaboration between school and adult service systems.

Key findings: state level policy analyses

- ❖ leadership through setting values, direction and creating the infrastructure for change
- ❖ Support coordination/case management to increase prioritization of employment
- ❖ Managing the employment process including sequencing funding with VR (in process)

Where are we going?



In the next 5-10 years, what should research focus on to more effectively align policy (**what we say we want**) with practice (**what we actually do**)?

think/move/vote!

Remember...



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Synthesis and Next Steps



Rehabilitation Research and Training Center on Advancing Employment
for Individuals with Intellectual and Developmental Disabilities

A project of

ThinkWork!

at the Institute for Community Inclusion, UMass Boston

www.ThinkWork.org

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